

Tryout evaluation plan

Fill in the session details. Adjust the sample workout to age, readiness and group size.

REUSABLE SESSION PLAN | ALL AGE GROUPS

LEAD COACH	DATE	TEAM	AGE GROUP
START TIME	FINISH TIME	PLAYER COUNT	ADULT HELPER

Goal: Evaluate skills, position fit, effort and response to coaching. The sample below is for 4-6 players with a coach and one adult helper. Run one active drill at a time.

ADAPT TO YOUR GROUP - COACHING GUIDELINE

Group	Suggested adaptation
Ages 5-8 / beginners	About 45-60 minutes. Use tee/coach feeds, fewer reps, short throws and untimed movement. Keep instructions simple.
Ages 9-12	About 60-75 minutes. Use controlled feeds and comfortable distances; increase reps only when players are ready.
Teen / advanced groups	Use the 90-minute sample. Add situational challenges and position looks when appropriate.

90-MINUTE SAMPLE - SHORTEN BLOCKS AS NEEDED

Minutes	Activity	Purpose
0-8	Check-in	Positions, recent throwing and readiness; explain the workout.
8-18	Warm-up	Easy movement, mobility and gradual build-ups.
18-28	Catch + throwing	Progressive warm-up, then measured target throws.
28-43	Defense	Ground balls and short, controlled outfield footwork.
43-65	Hitting	Warm-up reps, baseline swings, one cue and a second look.
65-77	Movement + IQ	First-step movement and age-appropriate game questions.
77-87	Second look	Revisit uncertain skills; watch how players apply instruction.
87-90	Wrap-up	Thank players and give parents a follow-up date.

Optional: Allow about 8 minutes per pitcher and 5 minutes per catcher after the core, or schedule separately. Confirm enough time before starting. Split groups larger than 6.

Prepare: Balls, tee, helmets, L-screen, cones, target/net, stopwatch and catcher gear. Check netting and clear running space. Helper feeds and supervises; coach evaluates. If alone, pause to record notes and allow extra time.

Using this PDF: Keep a blank master and save a named copy per player/session. Page 3 is the player form; page 4 is the group summary. Totals are entered manually.

What to watch at each station

Adapt difficulty to experience; record actual reps and distances.

DRILL GUIDE | USE COMPARABLE FEEDS WITHIN EACH GROUP

1 THROWING + DEFENSE

Throwing: After progressive catch, use 6-8 target throws at a comfortable, measured distance for the group. Shorten it for beginners. Record target hits / attempts, distance, footwork, release and repeatability. No maximum-effort arm test.

Ground balls: Beginners: 4-6 gently rolled balls. Experienced players: up to 10 (4 routine, 2 forehand, 2 backhand, 2 slow rollers). Use similar feeds and replace unplayable balls. Record clean fields / attempts; observe ready position, first step, hands and transfer.

Outfield: Use 2-4 short drop-step or angle reps with controlled soft tosses below the ceiling. For beginners, start with basic tracking and catching. Indoor reps cannot establish full outfield range; note outdoor reads for follow-up.

2 HITTING

Beginners: Start with tee contact; use 6-8 graded swings after a few warm-ups. Add gentle coach toss only if appropriate. **Experienced players:** 4 tee warm-ups, 8 graded front-toss swings, one brief cue, then 4 more swings. Record the feed method and actual graded count.

Observe: Solid contact, timing, barrel control, balance and response to the cue. Keep feeds comparable and replace bad feeds. Use a helmet and screened feeder. Judge pitch selection only when the drill supports it; tee/front-toss success is not proof against live pitching.

3 MOVEMENT, GAME KNOWLEDGE + COACHABILITY

Movement: Beginners: untimed starts, stops and direction changes. Experienced players: two 10-yard starts only with clear turf and ample stopping space; use the same timer/start method. Record the drill used. Compare like drills within the same age group, not across ages.

Game knowledge: Beginners: ask where to run after a fair hit and how to get an out at first. Experienced players: ask about force plays with a runner on first, or retouching/tagging after a caught fly. Use a simple demonstration when needed; note what they understand after instruction.

Coachability: Give one clear cue and watch the next 3-5 reps. Look for attention, an attempt to apply it, effort and response after a mistake. Quiet players can be highly coachable; do not grade loudness or personality.

4 OPTIONAL PITCHER / CATCHER LOOK

Pitchers: For players already pitching in player-pitch divisions, allow about 8 minutes each. Check recent workload and readiness, then re-warm without rushing. Use a brief sample of familiar pitches (up to 8-12, fewer if appropriate). Record strikes / attempts and repeatability. Skip bullpens for tee-ball/coach-pitch evaluations; assess basic throwing instead.

Catchers: Allow about 5 minutes in full gear: 6 receives, 4 controlled blocks and 3 short target throws; simplify for beginners. Watch setup, recovery and footwork. Do not report full-distance pop times indoors. Use a protected adult or target for bullpens; schedule a dual-role player's other look separately.

Session rule: Ask about recent games, lessons, bullpens, preparation and soreness. Stop throwing for pain or unusual fatigue. Mark missed throwing as N/O and arrange another look. Evaluation reps are not medical clearance or a game pitch limit.

Pitch Smart: Check the player's age-specific pitch limits and required rest across all teams before pitching; monitor fatigue. MLB / USA Baseball Pitch Smart - [select the appropriate age group](#)

Individual player scorecard

Rate only what you observed. Use the same difficulty and scale within each age group.

SAVE ONE COPY PER PLAYER | PRINTABLE OR FILLABLE

PLAYER NAME	NUMBER	AGE GROUP	DATE	TEAM

EVALUATOR	PRIMARY / OTHER POSITIONS	BATS	THROWS	THROW TODAY?
		-	-	-

RECENT THROWING (DATES / COUNTS / TEAMS)	SORENESS / READINESS NOTES

1 Needs instruction | **2** Inconsistent | **3** Functional in controlled reps
4 Consistent | **5** Consistent and adapts to challenge | **N/O** Not observed (never zero)

Category	Rating	Evidence / specific example
Contact / barrel control	-	
Hitting approach / balance	-	
Fielding hands / feet	-	
Throw accuracy / transfer	-	
Athletic movement	-	
Baseball knowledge	-	
Coachability / effort	-	

TOTAL / 35 - enter manually only when all seven categories are rated.
 N/O or a missing score = Pending. No automatic roster cutoff.

THROW / REPS	CLEAN GB / REPS	OF / REPS	CONTACT / REPS	MOVEMENT / TIMES	STRIKES / REPS

DRILL DETAILS (FEED METHOD / THROW DISTANCE / CATCHING)

BEST SKILL / POSSIBLE ROLE	CUE RESPONSE / NEEDS ANOTHER LOOK

NEXT STEP	FOLLOW-UP OWNER	FOLLOW-UP DATE	INITIALS
-			

Compare, then decide

Save a group copy for each tryout. Keep unresolved decisions open for later looks.

STAFF REVIEW | KEEP EVALUATIONS PRIVATE

TRYOUT DATE

AGE GROUP / TEAM

EVALUATOR(S)

Review: Finish individual notes before discussing players. Compare independent observations when two coaches evaluate. Consider current skills, response to instruction and position fit. Do not let body size, one swing or one error decide.

Next steps: Consider invite = roster discussion; Callback = specific missing look; Development = strength plus improvement target; Incomplete = arrange a fair later evaluation.

ACTUAL ROSTER PRIORITIES

CATCHER

INFIELD

OUTFIELD

PITCHING

OTHER

Enter complete totals only. Use "Pending" when any score is missing. Compare players within the same age group and drill setup.

Player / #	/ 35	Position fit	Best evidence	Needs a look	Next step
					-
					-
					-
					-
					-
					-

FOLLOW-UP PLAN

"Invite?" means consider an invitation; review before making an offer. Confirm contact details and schedule availability separately from the skill score.

FOLLOW-UP OWNER

PARENT RESPONSE DATE

NEXT EVALUATION / NOTES

Tell parents when they will hear back. Share individual feedback privately; do not announce rankings.